

— Reporting **Fashion** | **Lifestyle** | **Creativity** | **Talent** for Nile University of Nigeria —

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Editorial Introduction

Proudly showcasing originality and creativity in the world of fashion and design, Mystique Magazine is a thriving student journal. We aim to highlight the lively and creative voices of our student contributors in every issue, giving them a forum to express themselves and share their innovative ideas.

The theme of our current issue is “Essence.” In this edition, we embark on a journey to explore the core elements that make fashion such a powerful medium for individual expression. Through the insightful and creative perspectives of our brilliant student writers, we delve into the myriad ways in which our personal style serves as a mirror to our true selves, capturing the distinct character and spirit of our era.

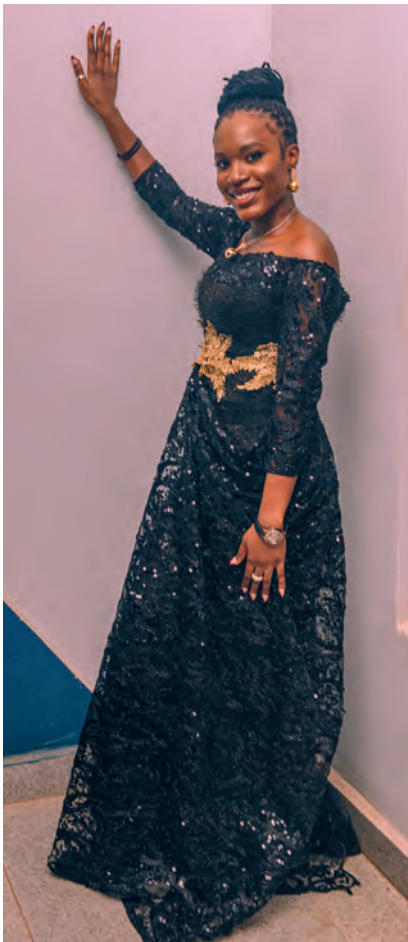
This issue highlights the variety and creativity of today’s student fashion. We show that fashion is about more than simply clothes by showcasing original and timeless designs alongside moving personal stories. Every piece and photo spread is a reflection of the authors’ unfiltered passion, which is what makes this campus the fashion capital of the world.

We invite you to join us on this exciting ride as we explore the rich tapestry of student fashion. Be prepared to be inspired by the creativity, innovation, and individuality that our students bring to the table. This issue of Mystique Magazine promises to be a testament to the vibrant fashion culture that thrives within our community, reflecting the essence of what it means to be truly expressive through clothing.

Daniel Osondu

Graphic Designer, Nile University of Nigeria

Campus Style Watch





The Latest Fashion Trends Among Nigerian Students

- By *Binta Bolous*

The fashion landscape among Nigerian students is a vibrant tapestry of diverse styles and influences. From the streets of Lagos to university campuses across the country, young Nigerians are redefining trends and expressing themselves through fashion like never before. Contemporary Nigerian fashion blends cultural heritage with global influences, resulting in a dynamic fusion of traditional attire, urban streetwear, and cutting-edge trends. This fusion reflects the creativity, confidence, and individuality of Nigerian youth, making the country a burgeoning hub for innovative fashion on the African continent.

At Nile University of Nigeria, the diverse student body showcases a vibrant array of fashion choices, reflecting a mix of cultural influences and personal styles. One of the striking observations on campus is the embrace of various fashion trends, each offering a unique glimpse into the evolving tastes and identities of Nigerian youth.

The Rise of Altè Style

Among the fashion-forward students at Nile University, the Altè trend has gained popularity. Altè fashion is characterized by its unconventional and artistic approach to clothing. Originating from Nigeria's alternative music and arts scene, the Altè style often features bold colours, vintage pieces, and eclectic accessories. It embraces individuality and creativity, offering a platform for self-expression beyond mainstream fashion norms. Students embracing Altè fashion can be seen sporting unique hairstyles, vintage clothing items, and creative makeup choices that set them apart on campus.





Drippers: **Braving the Heat with Steeze**

On the other end of the spectrum, some students embody what I like to call the “Drippers.” Despite Nigeria’s scorching heat, these trendsetters embrace elaborate layering and intricate outfit combinations in pursuit of “steeze” (a fusion of style and ease). You’ll often spot them in multiple layers of clothing, accessorized with hats, scarves, and statement sneakers. While their dedication to fashion is admirable, the hot climate sometimes leads to them dripping with sweat—an undeniable proof of their commitment to looking effortlessly cool.

The Comfortable Classics

Of course, not every student at Nile University is chasing the latest trends. There’s a sizable group of students who prefer a more laid-back and practical approach to dressing. This category gravitates towards timeless basics—think comfy tees paired with jeans or casual dresses. Their style is understated yet

functional, perfect for navigating the demands of student life.

The Bold Mixers: **Celebrating Individuality with Unconventional Pairings**

Amidst the sea of styles, there’s also a group of students who embrace a more unconventional approach. They mix and match colours and patterns in ways that defy traditional fashion rules, creating eye-catching and daring outfits that celebrate individuality and artistic expression.

Diverse Choices, Common Ground

What’s fascinating about the fashion scene at Nile University is its diversity. Despite the spectrum of styles, there’s a sense of inclusivity and respect for individual expression. Students are free to experiment with their looks while adhering to the university’s dress code guidelines, which prioritize modesty and decency.

In essence, the fashion trends at Nile University of Nigeria reflect the broader cultural landscape of the country, blending tradition with innovation and personal flair. Whether you’re an Altè enthusiast, a Dripper defying the heat, or someone who prefers the comfort of classics or bold mixers, one thing is clear—the campus is a canvas where students paint their identities through the language of style.





From Fast Fashion to Green Glamour

The Rise of Sustainable Clothing

- By Jawahir Kamilu Babanmallam

Over the years, the fashion industry has experienced a variety of trends, undergoing profound transformations with time. From fast, cheap and disposable fashion to the rise of sustainable fashion and eco-friendly choices, the fashion industry is becoming more environmentally aware and making conscious efforts towards mitigating negative environmental impacts. Today, consumers of fashion industry products are embracing green glamour, merging style with environmental preservation.

Fast fashion, characterized by the rapid production of cheap and trendy clothing, relies on environmentally hazardous materials and fast-paced production cycles that generate significant waste. Additionally, it often overworks production staff to meet the ever-changing demands of consumers. This industry has been widely criticized for its harmful impacts on society and the environment. However, a positive shift is emerging, as sustainable and eco-friendly choices are starting to take center stage, capturing the attention

and preference of fashion enthusiasts and consumers.

Sustainable clothing is derived from eco-friendly materials such as recycled polyester, organic cotton, bamboo, tencel/lyocell (man-made material gotten from wood pulp), hemp, upcycled fabric, materials made from agricultural waste and other environmentally safe materials that degrade easily when disposed of and leave a smaller carbon footprint because of the green industrial processes used in their production. It also ensures ethically secured working environments for staff involved in production. Sustainable clothing doesn't mean giving up style, on the contrary, it presents consumers with a unique fashion statement that has a green card from mother nature.

Designers and style pace setters have hopped on the sustainable train, creating awareness for what it means when the term, 'green glamour' pops up. Stella McCartney is one of such trailblazers, paving the way for green fashion with her advocacy for sustainability, use of

vegetarian leather and implementing eco-friendly manufacturing processes. Her brand has continued to reflect the beauty of fashion blended with sustainability.

Other brands walking the talk of sustainable fashion include Reformation, a label that uses Tencel and other eco-friendly materials in the production of its vintage-inspired designs. Everlane is another such brand known for its transparent supply chains and eco-friendly material choices. Mainstream brands are not left out as H&M recently launched their Conscious Collection, boasting several wears made from sustainable materials.

Sustainable clothing is not just a passing trend or fashion fad, it is the beginning of a drastic shift in how we view clothing. Consumers are enlightened on how their fashion choices affect the environment around them and what they can do to make a difference. At the end of the day, it is not just an outfit. It is a statement, and choosing sustainable fashion is saying I stand with Mother Nature.

Fashion Tips

**Know Your Body Type:**

Understanding your body shape will help you choose clothes that flatter your figure.

**Layering:**

Learn to balance fabrics and colours to create a comfortable and stylish outfit.

**Invest in Basics:**

Essential pieces like a white shirt, black jeans, and a tailored blazer can be mixed and matched with various outfits.

**Neutral Colors:**

Build a wardrobe with neutral colors as they are versatile and can be paired with almost anything.

**Fit is Key:**

Always choose clothes that fit well. Avoid items that are too tight or too loose.

**Mix Textures:**

Combining different textures can add interest to your outfit.

**Quality Over Quantity:**

Invest in a few high-quality pieces rather than numerous low-quality items.

**Tailor Your Clothes:**

If off-the-rack clothes don't fit perfectly, visit a tailor to make necessary adjustments.

**Accessorize Smartly:**

Accessories can elevate a simple outfit. Choose statement pieces like bold necklaces, scarves, or hats.

**Keep it Balanced:**

If you're wearing a voluminous top, pair it with slim-fitting bottoms, and vice versa.



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A chat with **Amina Mohammed** CEO, Anada Couture

Could you briefly describe your educational background and the steps you took to go from it to becoming a fashion designer?

I majored in Computer Science at Nile University of Nigeria and applied my skills to start “Anada Nigeria”. I began with small trades such as perfume, wrappers and more. Then I partnered with a tailor and grew my fashion business through referrals.

Through referrals, my business expanded, and I converted our home courtyard into a mini workshop. As my customer base grew, I relocated to a shop in Maitama, and later to a more strategic location at Suite A23, 2nd floor, Plot 6, Abraham Plaza, A. E. Ekuinam Street (next to ABC transport), Utako, and expanded my services. Additionally, I took fashion courses at Hudayya Fashion School, enhancing my skills in tailoring, illustration, and design.

What motivated you to make such a significant career shift?

The desire to turn my passion into a career motivated me to make a significant shift. I’ve always been driven by a passion for creating unique fashion and clothing styles, inspired by my creativity and imagination.

How has your educational background affected the way you approach fashion design?

My educational background has had a profoundly positive impact on my approach to fashion design. My degree in Computer Science from Nile University of Nigeria taught me valuable skills in problem-solving,

critical thinking, and attention to detail, which I now apply to my fashion design work. Additionally, my fashion courses at Hudayya Fashion School honed my skills in tailoring, illustration, and design.

What was your experience like studying at Nile University of Nigeria, and how did it prepare you for your career change?

My experience at Nile University of Nigeria was both challenging and rewarding. As I progressed through my program, I increasingly enjoyed my courses, particularly in my third and fourth years. The curriculum was rigorous, but it prepared me well for the demands of the tech industry. My final project, an Android-based mobile app for e-commerce, was a highlight of my studies. It showcased the power of technology in driving online marketing and sales, and this insight has been invaluable in my fashion career. The project’s success gave me the confidence to pursue a career change, leveraging my technical skills to drive innovation in the fashion industry. Nile University’s strong foundation in computer science and entrepreneurship studies empowered me to transition into fashion design, armed with a unique perspective and skill set to generate revenue.

How would you describe your design style?

My design style is a fusion of “haute couture” (mostly for bespoke) and casual outfits (mostly for my Ready-to-Wear, blending high-end fashion with wearable, everyday style. I aim





to create unique pieces that exude elegance and sophistication yet remain accessible and comfortable for my clients.

What are the key influences and inspirations behind your work?

My work is deeply influenced by two main sources: Fabric and Nature. I find inspiration in the textures, patterns, and colours of various fabrics, which I often combine in innovative ways to create unique and striking designs. Nature also plays a significant role in my creative process, as I draw inspiration from its forms, shapes, and colours. Such as patterns on a leaf, the vibrant hues of a sunset, etc.

What materials and techniques do you prefer to work with, and why?

I have a strong affinity for working with silk due to its exceptional properties. Silk's luxurious smoothness, soft texture, and elegant appearance make it a joy to work with. Additionally, its skin-friendly nature ensures that the garments I create are not only beautiful but also comfortable to wear. I prefer silk because of its luxurious texture, elegant appearance, soft and smooth feel, and skin friendly.

How do you approach sustainability and ethical practices in your designs?

I embed sustainability and ethical practices into my design philosophy by creating timeless, modest pieces that defy affordable apparel and selecting responsibly sourced fabrics from suppliers who share my values. Also, I prioritize quality over quantity to reduce waste and support ethical labour

practices.

What has been the biggest challenge you've faced as a designer, and how did you overcome it?

Getting my tailors to deliver on time. I put them through processes that work easier for them, and results come out as needed. Another challenge is having to be involved in fabric sourcing and making decisions in the market, and sometimes these decisions happen to be a bit tough.

What has been your proudest moment or biggest achievement in your career so far?

Developing my fashion brand into a high-end luxury brand. I started from my parents' courtyard to my own high-end office at a strategic location. This is an achievement because aside from the fact that I scaled from home to own an office outside home (my present location), it took time, effort, and resources, to boost sales, build relationships, reach targets, and get there. Another achievement is having my company "Anada" represent northern Nigeria in showcasing the northern attire of Hausa Fulani in the last presidential inauguration exhibition at the International Conference Centre, Abuja. (As in the picture below)

What advice would you give to aspiring fashion designers?

To aspiring fashion designers, I would say develop your unique style and aesthetic, Stay true to your vision, but be open to learning and growth, and most importantly, be sure you meet your customer satisfaction.

Who are your style icons or favourite designers, and why?

- Elie Saab because of his exotic designs of bridals
- Nizar Rounani because of his choice of fabrics.

If you could design an outfit for anyone, past or present, who would it be and why?

Hudayya Fadoul Abacha and Miss Funke Folorunsho Alakija

What are your goals for the future, both personally and for your brand?

My long-term goals are to leverage my skills, wealth, and experience to drive positive change in Nigeria's business landscape. I aim to partner with like-minded groups to advocate for business reforms and sustainable development (SDG-8), and continuously create jobs and wealth, aligning with the United Nations' Sustainable Development Goals. Through my brand, I strive to be a catalyst for a positive impact on society, empowering individuals to alleviate poverty and for communities to thrive.

Where can our readers find your work and follow your journey?

My social media handles: Instagram- (@anada.ng, @anada.man)
Facebook: Anada Nigeria, anada.man

Are there any final words of wisdom for current students pursuing their passions?

Success is nice but failure is nice too because they both teach us a lesson. So don't feel bad if you fail. Keep striving but learn lessons from your mistakes.

Exploring the Cultural Significance of Traditional Attires

- By Uchechi Genevieve Anyanwu



From the very start of human civilization, we have utilised clothing not only to protect ourselves from the elements but also as a means of self-expression. However, traditional attire which exposes a different layer of expression of a people is also utilised as a rich tapestry depicting the opulent history and traditions of various cultures irrespective of geographical location, from the lost Mayan Empire of Central America to the old Benin Kingdom of West Africa.

These traditional attires were historically used to express one's standing in society, and this can be seen in the Igbo community whereby the Okpu Agu (tiger hat) or the Okpu Ozo (red cap) is used to express the chieftaincy rank of men in the society. In the entertainment industry, the Okpu Agu

has been notably seen on Afro Rap artist Odumodublvck and this further highlights the importance of our cultural attires and accessories as a means of self-expression.

In addition, the Bubu, Agbada or Baban Riga which is a traditional attire consisting of a long-sleeved shirt, a pair of tie-up trousers that narrow at the ankles, and an open-stitched overflowing wide sleeveless gown worn over these two for the men; for the women, it consists of a wrapper and a wide gown usually accompanied by an intricate head scarf. This can be traced as far back as the 8th century West Africa as it was first worn by the Islamicized people of the Takrur and Ghanaian Empire. This garment was historically worn by nobles and the embroidered fabric used to create these garments

had specific meanings, depicting the ethnic community and regions of these nobles. Nowadays, the bubu is worn throughout Nigeria and various African countries and is made from textiles such as cotton or more expensive materials such as silk. Fashion houses such as Dye Lab founded in 2020 by fashion veteran Rukky Ladoja have utilised the Bubu design as a means of personal expression using a multicoloured Aso`oke fabric in numerous variations.

As stated by the renowned author Chinua Achebe, "The warp and weft of African textiles are the visual embodiment of our culture's beating heart." This statement wholly encompasses the vast importance of our textiles and traditional attires as they can tell stories and convey messages that have been woven into the fabric of our heritage for centuries.



Navigating the Intersection: Fashion Influencers & Social Media Analytics

- By Kono Michael Achua



In the constant evolution of fashion trends and digital influence, the close connection between fashion influencers and social media analytics has gained popularity. Understanding how fashion influencers use data and analytics to drive trends and interact with their audience has become increasingly important as the digital environment continues to alter consumer behaviour and redefine trendsetting patterns. This article digs into the multifaceted connection between fashion influencers, technology tools, and social media analytics, examining how knowledge gained from data shapes the growth of fashion trends and consumer engagement. From observing the variables that drive

successful collaborations to examining the ethical implications inherent in data-driven influencer initiatives, this article sheds light on the diverse areas where fashion, technology, and social influence intersect.

Fashion influencers use a variety of analytics tools to analyze data, improve their approaches, and boost their online reach. The possibilities range from full social media management platforms to specialized analytics tools designed specifically for the world of fashion. What analytics tools you may ask, well, from research I can list out one such tool, Dash Hudson, a platform which provides fashion influencers with an in-depth analysis of Instagram performance, with

features like audience demographics, engagements analytics, and content optimization tips, allowing influencers to make data-driven decisions to improve their content strategy and audience engagement. More tools include Hootsuite and the AI-powered analytic tool, ListenFirst, which has changed the entire game of how fashion influencers utilize data, helping them stay ahead of the curve and build a steady following.

I asked a couple of fashion creatives about their work style and how social media data and analytics have shaped how they reach their audience and its general impact on their work, here are a few statements that stood out to me:



Yiokie Abang of Yioks Fashion, states how *“passion and the ability to build people’s self-esteem through styling”* inspired her to start up her brand, Yioks Fashion, a styling house. When asked about an instance where she effectively used data and analytics to reach a wider audience she states, “An instance involved leveraging a fashion styling content I created to run Instagram ads. The campaign resulted in a significant increase in followers, and the data gathered from the content provided valuable insights for further analysis”. The fashion stylist agreed to how much technology tools have aided her brand in creating content and connecting to her targeted audience “It has provided more visibility and has helped reached out to a larger audience”, she also stated Capcut, Facetune video, TikTok and AI as some of the technology tools used in creating engaging content for her brand.

Oladotun Oshadami of Da Aso, an alumnus of Nile University, was asked the same questions and his answers were not far from what the previous creative said, in his words his inspiration stemmed from wanting “to provide an opportunity for fashion content creators to advise and help other people who

struggle with their style and what to wear day to day...”. To enable them to reach out to more fashion creatives and other brands to partner with them, they uploaded their first idea on the social media application, TikTok because they understood the difficulty in reaching out to creatives individually so, this way they can utilize the app and have a wider audience engagement.

The use of social media data and analytics has been at the forefront of content creation and reaching out to a wider audience to boost audience engagement, creating that one post is not nearly enough, the use of technology tools to boost the content created to reach a wider audience is critical to know and understand. One can see how easy technology has made it for people looking for their style or just a daily ‘fit’ to go on their preferred fashion influencer social media page and discover the unending barrage of looks they can get inspiration from. The data obtained from the day-to-day use of social media and its engagements provides not just consumers but fashion influencers a more effective way of creating more content and in turn, making it easy for the consumers to view and engage with their favourite creatives.



**“passion and
the ability to
build people’s
self esteem
through styling”**

In conclusion, we cannot deny the fact that technology has greatly improved and widened the reach of fashion creatives but to every upside there is a downside, so what are the ethical considerations creatives consider when using data and analytics to boost their audience reach? Here’s what Oladotun Oshadami had to say: “...if a user has not consented to provide that personal information, I don’t think it’s ethical to get such personal information about people”, speaking on the use of a user’s data to create content and boost audience engagement. In essence, one would worry about the privacy of a user’s data and the use of their personal information gathered from social media. As fashion influencers collect and analyze data to enhance their content and target specific demographics, they must also comply with privacy guidelines while still respecting their audience’s privacy

Nile Pageant Show



Nile University's Pageantry Show was a spectacular fusion of glamour, talent, and cultural celebration, showcasing the creativity and school spirit of our students.

With a dynamic blend of music, dance, fashion, and more, the annual event brought together students, faculty, and staff for an unforgettable evening. Our students dazzled with stunning costumes and captivating performances, highlighting their unique styles and talents.

Relive the magic of this special night by flipping through our pages, where the essence of creativity, diversity, and school spirit comes alive.

Meet the Winners

Atayero Ilesanmi
Mr. Nile

Yakndara Udo-Imeh
Ms. Nile

Nwanekezie Somtochukwu Melvyn
Mr. Culture

Asma'u Abdumalik Durunguwa
Ms. Culture

Isaac Akuchukwu Isaac
Mr. Photogenic

Safiya Ahmed Almustapha
Ms. Photogenic





Tips for Practicing Mindfulness: A Guide to Using Meditation and Breathing to **Manage Stress, Anxiety, and Promote Emotional Well-being**

- By Aisha Yasmin Aliyu

Meditation involves using mental and physical techniques to focus or clear your mind, achieving a calm and stable state. A great tool for this is mindfulness, which focuses on thoughts, feelings, and bodily sensations to increase awareness, self-perception, concentration, and mental clarity.

Beginner's Guide to Meditation and Mindfulness

1. **Breath Awareness (5-15 minutes):** Focus on your natural breathing, noticing the sensation of air moving in and out or the rise and fall of your belly. If your mind wanders, gently refocus on your breath.
2. **Guided Meditation:** Use a guided meditation app or recording to help you stay focused. Popular apps include Smiling Mind, Calm, Headspace, and Insight Timer.

Managing Stress and Anxiety Through Breathing: The 4-7-8 Breathing Technique

A popular breathing exercise for managing stress and anxiety is the 4-7-8 technique, based on pranayama, an ancient yogic practice. Here's how to do it:

- Find a comfortable, quiet spot.





- Breathe in through your nose for 4 seconds.
- Hold your breath for 7 seconds.
- Breathe out slowly through your mouth for 8 seconds, making a whooshing sound.

Repeat this cycle three more times. Start with four cycles and gradually increase to eight. You may feel lightheaded initially, but this will pass.

Benefits of Mindful Breathing

Regular mindfulness and

breathing can enhance cognitive ability, mood regulation, and slow brain aging. They also help with anxiety, depression, stress, and emotional well-being. But how can something as simple as breathing be so beneficial? Our autonomic nervous system, which controls involuntary functions like heart rate and digestion, is divided into the sympathetic (fight or flight) and parasympathetic (rest and digest) systems. Stress activates the sympathetic system, raising heart rate and blood pressure. Breathing activates

the parasympathetic system, promoting relaxation.

Mindful breathing also lowers blood pressure, reduces chronic pain, improves sleep, increases information processing speed, and enhances metacognitive awareness.

Meditate in the morning to set a calm tone for the day or at night for better sleep and relaxation. The key is to find a meditation style and schedule you can stick to consistently.

Fun Facts

Absolutely, fashion has a rich history and plenty of fun facts to explore. Here are some interesting tidbits:



High Heels Were Originally for Men

In the 1600s, high heels were popularized by men, especially aristocrats, to signify status and wealth. Women only started wearing them later to mimic men's fashion.



The Bikini Was Named After a Nuclear Explosion

French fashion designer Louis Réard named the bikini after Bikini Atoll, where the United States tested nuclear bombs. He believed the swimsuit would cause a similar explosive reaction.



Jeans Were Invented for Miners

Levi Strauss and Jacob Davis created denim jeans in the 1870s as durable work pants for miners during the California Gold Rush. They never imagined they would become a fashion staple.



The First Fashion Magazine Was Published in Germany

The first fashion magazine, "*Journal des Luxus und der Moden*," was published in Germany in 1786. It featured illustrations of the latest Parisian fashion trends.

The Most Expensive Dress Ever Made

The Nightingale of Kuala Lumpur, designed by Faisal Abdullah from the Jendela fashion house, is the world's most expensive dress, valued at \$30 million. Released in 2009, the crimson silk and taffeta gown is embellished with over 750 diamonds, totalling over 1,000 carats.



The First Fashion Mannequin

In 19th-century Paris, a tailor crafted the first fashion mannequin from wood and wax, revolutionizing garment display and enchanting passersby with lifelike elegance in shop windows.



The First Time Makeup Was Used

In ancient Egypt around 4000 BC, Cleopatra's ancestors used kohl, a black powder made from galena (a lead-based ore), to line their eyes, marking the first recorded use of makeup for cosmetic purposes.



The Bra Was Invented by a Socialite

Mary Phelps Jacob, a New York socialite, invented the modern bra in 1913 out of two handkerchiefs and a ribbon. She patented her design as the "Backless Brassiere."

“

As a contributing photographer for this edition of the mystique magazine, I had the unique opportunity to capture the essence of our vibrant community. I aimed to showcase the diversity, energy, and spirit that make our school special. Each image in this magazine tells a story of academic achievements, artistic expressions, and the everyday moments that bring us together. My goal was to create a visual narrative that complements the written articles. I hope these photographs allow you to see Nile University of Nigeria through a new lens, highlighting the beauty and uniqueness of our shared experiences. Thank you for enjoying reading these edition and stay tuned for the next.

Chieloka Nweze*(boyeliza)*

”



Meet the Team

Gerald Osugo

Chief Marketing Officer

Rogbitan Seun Joshua

Creative Lead

Daniel Osondu

Graphic Designer / Project Manager

Aluoghor Chris

Senior Photographer

Austin Nwaneri

Media Officer

Blessing Ologun

Photographer

Ekezimero Eto

Chief Editor / Marketing Communications Manager

Oseghale Jacinta

Editor / Marketing Communications Officer

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Jawahir Kamilu Babanmallam

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